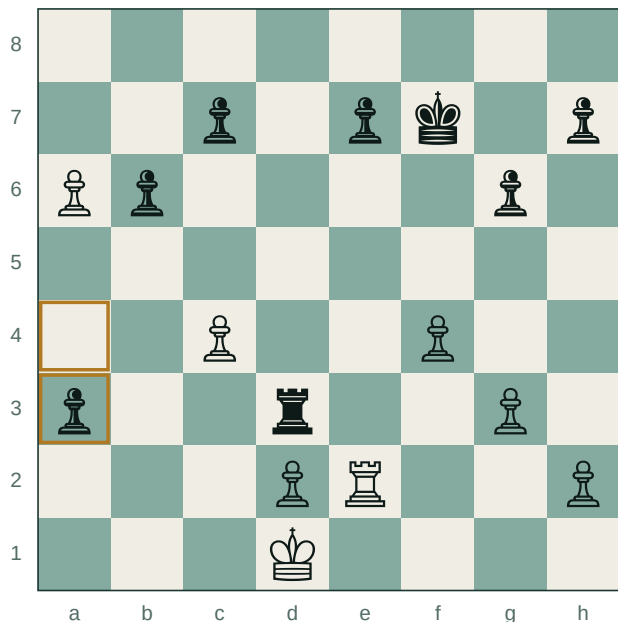


Advanced-pawn tactics: White, move 34

Advanced-pawn tactics

White to move



Previous move: 33...a3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34. a7 Rd8 35. Re3 a2 36. Ra3

34.a7 The pawn moves from a6 to a7. Recorded reply: **34...Rd8**.

35.Re3 The rook moves from e2 to e3. Recorded reply: **35...a2**.

36.Ra3 The rook moves from e3 to a3.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on f7. Geometrically undefended: rook on d3. Check for tactical protection.